

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
 ♥ 9 6 4
 ♦ K 8 6 3
 ♣ J 10 8 6 2

♠ A J 9 4

♥ A K Q J 10

♦ A

♣ A K 5



♠ Q 10 8 5 3 2

♥ 7 3

♦ Q J 10

♣ 9 4

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 7 3

West	North	East	South
	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	6 ♥		
All Pass			

6 ♥ by North

Lead: ♦ Q

would then get the lead and pull your two remaining trumps. That would leave one trump in dummy to ruff his ♠ J, his only remaining loser.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦ Q, you signaled with the ♦ 8 and North won the ♦ A.

North then played low to dummy's ♠ K, and led dummy's ♠ 6. Your decision is not whether to play high or low, but whether to ruff or not, which amounts to the same thing.

Do not ruff.

Even though North holds the ♠ A, if you ruff now he will just put on a small ♠ and you will be ruffing a loser. Instead discard a ♦.

North will win the ♠ A, but will not be able to ruff any ♠ losers in dummy because your trumps can overruff any of South's trumps.

Suppose you had ruffed the ♠. North would have played his ♠ 9, leaving himself with ♠ A J. He

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 6 3
 ♥ A K 10 9 8
 ♦ 8 2
 ♣ 10 9 4

♠ A 10 7 4

♥ J 6 5 2

♦ 9 5 4

♣ 5 3



♠ K 8 5

♥ 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ A 7 6 2

♠ Q 9 2

♥ Q 3

♦ Q J 10 6

♣ K Q J 8

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

1♦

Pass

All Pass

1NT by East

Lead: ♣K

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣K and continue with the ♣J then ♣Q, taken by East's ♣A. To trick 4 East plays the ♥4. What do you play?

Play the ♥Q.

To see why you should play the ♥Q, just visualize the result if you play low. East will finesse with dummy's ♥8. If North wins his ♥J on this trick there will be 4 good ♥ tricks in dummy. If North withholds his ♥J then Declarer will have 3 ♥ winners.

Now visualize the result of playing the ♥Q. Whether East takes this trick or not he cannot win more than 2 ♥s.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6
♥ 10 9 8 7
♦ J 9 6 3
♣ 9 5

♠ K Q 5

♥ A 6 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ A J 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 2

♥ K Q 4

♦ K Q 7 5

♣ Q 7 2

♠ 10 8 4 3

♥ J 5 2

♦ 10 4

♣ K 10 8 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

1NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♥10

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥10, won by dummy's ♥A. At trick 2 South calls for dummy's ♣3.

Play the ♣6.

You would not have been expecting South to play a small ♣ from dummy's holding. The only way it makes sense is if South holds the ♣Q.

If you play your ♣K you will win the trick, but in so doing you will set up 3 ♣ tricks for South, which is all he needs to make the slam.

Play low instead and South will win his ♣Q. But now your ♣ K 10 sits behind dummy's ♣ J 4 so he can get only one more trick in the suit, the ♣A.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ A Q 8 6 5 2
 ♦ A K
 ♣ 6 2

♠ J 10 9 6
 ♥ —
 ♦ 10 8 6 4 3
 ♣ A 8 4 3



♠ K 7 2
 ♥ K J 10 9 3
 ♦ 7 2
 ♣ K J 10

♠ 8 4 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ Q J 9 5
 ♣ Q 9 7 5

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1♥	Pass	3♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♣	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by West			
Lead: ♠J			

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠J, the ♠K is played from dummy and holds the trick. Next come dummy's ♥K, then another trump to West's ♥A.

At trick 4 West plays the ♣2 from his hand and you must decide what to play.

Play the ♣3 (smoothly).

West has 2 small ♣s and faces a choice of dummy plays in the suit. He must decide whether to play you for the ♣A or the ♣Q. If you play your ♣A you make the decision very easy for him.

When you correctly play your small ♣ life becomes harder for West. Sometimes he will guess correctly and play dummy's ♣K, but other times he will play dummy's ♣J, hoping you have the ♣Q.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 9 3
 ♥ Q 9 8
 ♦ A 7 3
 ♣ 10 8 5 4

♠ K Q J
 ♥ A K 7 3
 ♦ Q 10 9 4
 ♣ 7 3



♠ 10 8 7 6 2
 ♥ 10 5 4
 ♦ K 6
 ♣ J 9 6

♠ 5 4
 ♥ J 6 2
 ♦ J 8 5 2
 ♣ A K Q 2

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♠6			

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠6. You won the ♠A and returned the ♠9, won by North's ♠Q.

North next played to dummy's ♣A and led the ♦2. What do you play?

Play the ♦A.

Count the points. North's 15-17 plus South's 11 plus your 10 comes to 36-38. So East has room for an Ace or a King, but no more.

East's second ♠ play was the 2, so it looks like he started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of North's ♠s looks like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

All this means that you should take your ♦A now and return your last ♠ to establish East's suit. Now East's ♦K will be an entry to the ♠s

If you play low, East will have to take the ♦K now, and although he can play a ♠ to establish the suit, he will not have an entry to be able to cash them.